Machine Guarding Checklist (29 CFR 1910.212)

For on-site inspections of machines and their guards.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.212

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A, and note the machine or asset ID.
2. Report each Defect to the supervisor, keep the machine out of use while employees are exposed, and record the fix.
3. The manufacturer's instructions, machine-specific OSHA standards and site rules may add checks.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.212: General requirements for all machines (Part 1910 Subpart O: Machinery and Machine Guarding) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-212-machinery-machine-guarding-all-machines

SECTION A | Guarding methods and guard mounting

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Hazards guarded Ref. 1910.212(a)(1)	Point of operation, ingoing nip points, rotating parts and sources of flying chips or sparks are each covered by at least one guarding method.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Other employees protected Ref. 1910.212(a)(1)	Guarding also protects employees working near the machine, not just the operator.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Guard fixed to machine Ref. 1910.212(a)(2)	Guard is fastened to the machine wherever attachment is possible; no loose or propped-up guards.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Off-machine guards secured Ref. 1910.212(a)(2)	Where a guard cannot be fastened to the machine, it is firmly secured elsewhere and stays in position.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Guard creates no hazard Ref. 1910.212(a)(2)	Guard has no feature that could injure someone, for example sharp edges, new pinch points or loose parts.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Point of operation

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
6	Point of operation identified Ref. 1910.212(a)(3)(i)	The area where the machine actually works on the material is identified for this machine.	☐	☐	☐	
7	Point of operation guarded Ref. 1910.212(a)(3)(ii)	Where the machine's operation exposes an employee to injury, a guard or device protects the working area.	☐	☐	☐	
8	Applicable standard met Ref. 1910.212(a)(3)(ii)	Guarding device conforms to any appropriate standard that applies to this machine type.	☐	☐	☐	
9	Danger zone unreachable Ref. 1910.212(a)(3)(ii)	Where no specific standard applies, the operator cannot place any body part inside the danger zone at any point in the operating cycle.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Point of operation

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
10	Hand tools usable Ref. 1910.212(a)(3)(iii)	Special hand tools let the operator place and remove material easily with hands kept out of the danger zone.	☐	☐	☐	
11	Hand tools not replacing guards Ref. 1910.212(a)(3)(iii)	Required guarding stays in place when hand tools are used; the tools only supplement it.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Listed machine types checked Ref. 1910.212(a)(3)(iv)	Any guillotine cutters, shears, alligator shears, power presses, milling machines, power saws, jointers, portable power tools, forming rolls or calenders on site have been checked for point-of-operation guarding.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Drums, fans and anchoring

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
13	Revolving drum enclosure Ref. 1910.212(a)(4)	Revolving drums, barrels and containers are enclosed by a guard.	☐	☐	☐	
14	Drum interlock Ref. 1910.212(a)(4)	With the enclosure open or removed, the drum, barrel or container cannot revolve; interlock tested.	☐	☐	☐	
15	Low fan blades guarded Ref. 1910.212(a)(5)	Every fan whose blade periphery sits under 7 feet from the floor or working level has a guard.	☐	☐	☐	
16	Fan guard openings Ref. 1910.212(a)(5)	No opening in the fan guard is larger than 1/2 inch, checked with a gauge or rule.	☐	☐	☐	
17	Fixed machines anchored Ref. 1910.212(b)	Machines designed for a fixed location are securely anchored and do not walk or move during operation.	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME